

Food, plant material and animal products that you bring or send to Australia may introduce harmful pests and diseases that could devastate our valuable agriculture and tourism industries, and unique environment. Before these goods are allowed into the country, they are assessed using X-ray, detector dogs and manual inspection.

If you are sending or bringing goods to Australia for a cultural or seasonal event, or returning from an event overseas with souvenirs, you will need to:

- be aware of what goods pose a high risk to Australia and may require treatment or destruction
- use our advice about safe alternative goods or souvenirs
- declare anything you are bringing or sending, so that it can be inspected by biosecurity officers at the border.

This will help you to avoid delays, extra costs, or loss of goods that are considered high risk.

You must declare any goods you are bringing or sending to Australia.

Mailed goods should include a complete list of the contents of the parcels and any postal declaration labels or forms required.

Goods brought into Australia by travellers must be declared. The declaration is a legal document.

When bringing goods:

- mark YES on your declaration if you are carrying certain food, plant material or animal products
- ensure all footwear, clothing and equipment used in rural areas or near animals is thoroughly cleaned and declared
- you will have the opportunity to voluntarily dispose of any goods of concern in the bins at the terminal.

If you do not dispose of biosecurity risk items and do not declare them you could be given an infringement notice of up to \$7,280 and face possible criminal prosecution. Your visa may also be cancelled and, if so, you will be refused entry into Australia and you may not be able to return to Australia for up to three years.

Declaring items does not automatically mean they will be confiscated.

- Goods that don't pose a biosecurity risk will be sent on or returned after inspection.
- If goods require treatment, you will be given the option to have them treated at your expense. It may take several weeks for the items to be treated and returned to you.
- Where treatment is not an option, the goods will not be permitted into Australia and you will be notified.

Common gifts and souvenirs for cultural or seasonal events

Check what goods to avoid, what may require treatment, and what we suggest as a safe option for you to bring or send to Australia.

Do not bring or send:

- bullet shells
- poppies
- rosemary
- soil
- wattle sprigs.

Items that may require treatment at your expense:

- sand contaminated with soil or driftwood.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- cooked Christmas cakes and puddings
- chocolates
- confectionary
- toys not containing animal or plant material.

Do not bring or send:

- bark or straw based goods
- fresh or dried conifer
- fresh fruit and vegetables
- fresh or dried holly
- fresh or dried mistletoe
- hampers (containing certain food, meat or plant material)
- pine cones
- potpourri
- raw nuts
- salami and other meats
- toys containing seeds and sand
- wreaths.

Products that present a biosecurity risk

Diwali gifts that may pose a biosecurity risk include:

- sweets such as burfi, ras malai, rasgulla and pedas
- products containing dairy
- fresh fruit and dried fruit

- spices and tea
- raw nuts, seeds and herbs
- flowers and plant material.

Refer to [BICON](#) for specific conditions.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- artificial flowers
- fabric, gold or silver beads and coins
- personalised photo items.

Diwali or Festival of Lights fact sheet

For further information on Diwali, download the following fact sheet.

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Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- artificial flowers
- chocolate
- personalised photo items
- cooked cakes
- biscuits
- buns.

Items that may require treatment at your expense:

- blown or painted egg shells
- dried plant material, such as grapevines or straw.

Do not bring or send:

- fresh fruit or plant material
- raw or cooked whole eggs
- uncanned animal products, including cooked lamb and pork
- used egg cartons.

Products that present a biosecurity risk

Eid al-Adha gifts that may pose a biosecurity risk include:

- fresh, dried or cooked meat
- holy water
- neem
- raw tobacco
- fresh and dried fruits, including dates, figs and pomegranates
- dairy products, including homemade sweets and desserts containing dairy ingredients
- biscuits, cakes and bread requiring refrigeration, or containing meat products
- nuts
- tea and herbs
- grains and pulses including rice, wheat, lentils, chickpeas and beans.

Refer to [BICON](#) for specific conditions.

Eid-al-Adha and Hajj fact sheet

For further information on Eid al-Adha and the Hajj, download the following fact sheet.

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Products that present a biosecurity risk

Eid al-Fitr gifts that may pose a biosecurity risk include:

- fresh and dried fruits, including dates, figs and pomegranates
- dairy products, including homemade sweets and desserts containing dairy ingredients
- biscuits, cakes and bread requiring refrigeration, or containing meat products
- nuts
- tea and herbs
- grains and pulses including rice, wheat, lentils, chickpeas and beans
- holy water
- neem
- fresh, dried or cooked meat
- raw tobacco.

Refer to [BICON](#) for specific conditions.

Eid-al-Fitr fact sheet

For further information on Eid al-Fitr, download the following fact sheet.

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Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- chocolate
- confectionery.

Do not bring or send:

- corn husk dolls
- pumpkins.

Do not bring or send:

- ground nuts
- traditional Indian sweets (mithai) which contain milk, such as barfi, mysore pak, gulab jamun, rasgulla, pedas or soan-papdi
- radish.

Common Lunar New Year gifts pose a high risk of introducing pests and diseases. To avoid this, gifts should be purchased in Australia.

Do not bring or send:

- meat products, including chicken, beef and pork sausages whether fresh, frozen, dried, preserved or cured
- whole eggs and products containing eggs, including duck eggs
- dairy products such as milk and yoghurt
- fresh and dried fruit including citrus, persimmons, lychees and longans
- other plant products including banana leaves and fresh bamboo shoots
- traditional herbal medicines containing ganoderma fungus or cordyceps
- rice.

Lunar New Year fact sheet

For further information on Lunar New Year, download the following fact sheet.

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Other languages

You can download this document in different languages.

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- [Chinese – Simplified / 简体中文 \(PDF 530 KB\)](#)
- [Chinese – Traditional / 繁體中文 \(PDF 539 KB\)](#)
- [Korean / 한국어 \(PDF 496 KB\)](#)
- [Vietnamese / Tiếng Việt \(PDF 467 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

You can listen to our [podcast](#) to learn more about Lunar New Year and biosecurity.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- mooncakes, with no meat, commercially prepared and packaged
- mooncakes with egg yolks and no meat, commercially prepared and packaged
- chocolate mooncakes.

Do not bring or send:

- fresh pomelo
- mooncakes containing meat or birds nest
- star fruit
- taro
- any other fresh fruit or vegetables.

Mid-Autumn Festival fact sheet

For further information on the Mid-Autumn Festival, download the following fact sheet.

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- [Chinese – Simplified / 简体中文 \(PDF 260 KB\)](#)
- [Chinese - Traditional / 繁體中文 \(PDF 751 KB\)](#)
- [Vietnamese / Tiếng Việt \(PDF 216 KB\)](#)

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Do not bring or send:

- conifer sprigs
- ornaments made with straw
- seeds.

Products that present a biosecurity risk

Raksha Bandhan gifts that may pose a biosecurity risk include:

- Rakhi threads made with seeds or flowers
- traditional Indian sweets (mithai) which contain milk, such as barfi, mysore pak, gulab jamun, rasgulla, pedas or soan-papdi
- biscuits, cakes and bread requiring refrigeration
- nuts
- tea and herbs
- grains and pulses including rice, wheat, lentils, chickpeas and beans.

Refer to [BICON](#) for specific conditions.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- cotton Rakhi threads with plastic, fabric, gold or silver beads
- gold or silver coins
- personalised photo items
- artificial flowers.

Raksha Bandhan (Rakhi) fact sheet

For further information on Raksha Bandhan, download the following fact sheet.

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Do not bring or send:

- lucky plant kits
- shamrocks
- shillelaghs
- straw crosses.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- artificial flowers
- dried shamrocks
- fabric, gold or silver beads and coins
- personalised photo items
- shamrocks embedded in plastic.

Do not bring or send:

- dried flowers
- fresh flowers.

Items that do not pose a biosecurity risk and are permitted:

- chocolate
- confectionary.

Special import conditions apply for:

- etrog
- myrtle branches
- palm branches
- willow branches.

Steps for bringing festival items into Australia

Before bringing these items into Australia, you must check the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) and search for your item to find out if you're allowed to carry it in your luggage.

Follow these steps on how to bring festival items into Australia.

- Visit BICON before you travel and check your items are:
 - a permitted species
 - from a permitted country
 - free from insects, disease symptoms and other contaminants, such as soil
 - packed in clean, new, pest-proof packaging and clearly labelled

- secured to prevent insect infestation and contamination before they are shipped to Australia
- You need to obtain a phytosanitary certificate from the exporting country's National Plant Protection Organisation (NPPO).
- When you arrive in Australia, a biosecurity officer will:
 - check your documents and phytosanitary certificate are valid
 - inspect the packaging for damage.
 - inspect your items for live insects, weed seeds, diseases and other contaminants.
- If contaminants are not found, you can take your festival items.
- If contaminants are found, the festival items will be sent to one of our laboratories to check if they are a biosecurity risk to Australia.
 - If the contaminants are not a biosecurity risk, we will release the items to you.
 - If the contaminants are a biosecurity risk, we will provide you with a list of options. These include treatment, destroying the goods or exporting them from Australia.
 - If treatment is chosen, the goods will be sent to an approved facility and the risk managed at your expense.

More information

If the goods you want to bring or send to Australia are not present in the advice above, you can check the department's [Passenger and mail enquiry](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/travelling/exhibitions-sporting-cultural-other-events/cultural-seasonal>